

S N Z # C L A S S I F I E D S

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@**Undisciplined** wants to
post *here* publicly but **not** at
Stacker Saloon publicly.

only he couldn't bc
#node problems :/

anyway, @**Undisciplined** is
a good and worthy follow if
you like rich discussion

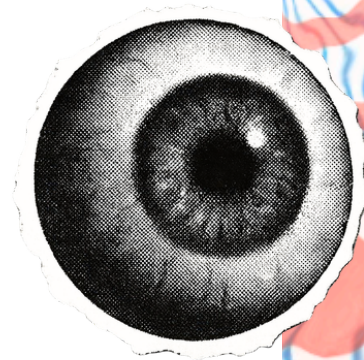


stacker news
weekly zine

Issue #68

AUG 15 - AUG 21

963 491



The top posts of this
week on stacker.news
created by @plebpoet

How do you cope with your own mediocrity?



5136 sats \ 94 comments \ @wackster 16 Aug AskSN

really makes you think

Do you prefer denial?

Or perhaps justification?

Or is it a temporary state?

The reality is that most of us aren't doing anything very impressive. We are small people who most will quickly forget, even if they have heard of us.

Discussion

1115 sats \ 4 replies \ @Kruw 16 Aug

I don't have children, but living vicariously through them seems like a decent solution.

★ 31 sats \ 3 replies \ @wackster OP 16 Aug
What if they are shits?

★ 151 sats \ 2 replies \ @optimism 16 Aug
Then you're less than mediocre because you fucked
up the one long-term job you had.

379 sats \ 7 replies \ @cryotosensei 16 Aug

I'm actually not bothered by it. These days, if I can get an afternoon off and laze around on my couch to catch up on my Netflix shows, I'm contented enough. No need to excel haha

★ 63 sats \ 6 replies \ @wackster OP 16 Aug
How do you think you will look back on those afternoons
when you are old?

★ 374 sats \ 4 replies \ @adlai 16 Aug
do you also judge yourself harshly for sleep?
living a humble life well is more admirable than delusions of
grandeur and eventual disappointment

179 sats \ 6 replies \ @siggy47 16 Aug

That's why God created alcohol

165 sats \ 3 replies \ @grimtechnet 16 Aug

"I'm mediocre" sounds like a lie that my monkey brain tells me.
I would delete the thought. Comparison is the thief of joy.

notez from the editor

summer comes to a
close, and with it,
SNZ's summer
subscription. What
shall we do next???

....a fall one....perhaps

browse, order, learn
about all zines here



anon brings the spice



At what point did we stop caring about freedom?

I came to Bitcoin for proof-of-work, the idea that one man's labor could not be stolen and *should not be stolen* from another and that Bitcoin was both a technological innovation...

And also an innovation for the Human Rights. Something that betters society. A mining machine (a CPU) on one side of the planet... could create coins that could be bought or purchased, traded or sent to the other side without a 3rd party or intermediary all based on the Distribution of Energy. That's what got me into Bitcoin and kept me up late these last few years.

How did it work?

How would it scale?

How would the users interact with it, and how exactly would people *ultimately* be drawn to Bitcoin? In other words what were the things that made people *use Bitcoin* when nothing else worked?

And could (or would) the government stop it?

I'm not a Bip-110er, I'm not and never have been a forker (bcash etc) and I'm not a pessimist yet I feel somehow we have lost our way.

The number of people I deal with in daily life that have exposure to "crypto" is very small, low single digits tops and Bitcoin specifically *an even smaller subset* of that group.

THEN take the number of people who actually self-custody any kind of cryptocurrency (a much smaller number) THEN take into account the people who have spent cryptocurrency on anything and the number drops further. Then take the percent of people who have ever spent Bitcoin on anything... and we're talking about a VERY small subset of people a small percentage of even 1%.

And that's exactly what I don't understand.

Where are the spenders?

Where are the merchants?

Where are the stores and vendors who accept Bitcoin (or any cryptocurrency?)

Where is the heart and soul of non-state money, the thrill and desire to separate Money and State?

Bitcoin cannot scale on "Layer One" no blockchain can... so that's why we have Lightning.

And despite what the 'critics' say Lightning actually works pretty well - just go to Steak n Shake or use Stacker News the technical demonstration as to what Lightning is and how it can work is actually very good.

Yet the world, the media, the financial press all of them are pretty much tone deaf... 'spending' Bitcoin is something they never mention under any circumstances... except to vaguely associate it with "crime" without explaining *how Bitcoin works* in any form or fashion. It's like the get-away robbery with no get-away driver... it literally doesn't make any sense and no-one explains it.

HAHA sucks for them I thought. Look at what they're missing! The reason they haven't 'joined us' (Team B) is because they just aren't ready yet. Any day now they'll join 'our team' Team Bitcoin because our team is clearly better.

But is it really? Is it REALLY them at fault?

What happens when the business blames the customer?

What happens when the business won't acknowledge their product *isn't that good...* or at least as good as it should be.

How long does the business last?

Perhaps Bitcoin just isn't what we thought - at least not in any reasonable time-frame and that's a big problem.

The government has done a damn fine job KYCing anything that flies, floats or fucks and Bitcoin has gotten *extra special* scrutiny. All the exchanges in the (allegedly) "free world" are heavily-KYCed, non-KYC is available but inconvenient in the best of times and between the disinformation and the relative sophistication that Bitcoin requires to use anyway...

The network isn't growing the number of users.

Not to mention hacks like the *ColdCard hack* aren't helping things to make a massive fucking understatement.

Then there have been the *major* pressures on all Bitcoin privacy tools, to include Coinjoins and everything else *plus* the privacy-focused developers themselves and now the Lightning infrastructure and tooling (Boltz for example that is recently and suddenly "offline.")

Lightning is a major 'upgrade' to Bitcoin privacy and usability... and I think it is no coincidence it is now being targeted or at least drawing 'extra special' scrutiny from governments even the ones masquerading as 'pro-crypto' while spending money they cannot possibly repay.

The same nation states that heavily restrict knife ownership, much less *basic* firearms (*gasp* guns!) in the hands of law-abiding people... were they so quickly going to acknowledge the existence of private money, separate from the state, that competes with their own which they fucking print up for free?

We were *so naive* so easily led and it shows.

Continued

Very, very few journalists' publications accept Bitcoin for donation.

Very few press groups accept it for donation even the ones with a tor address (a surprising number actually) and even those Human Rights groups that do accept 'crypto' for donation...

Will only accept Bitcoin from a "Coinbase" wallet which is a glorified bank account it isn't on chain anyway and then it is completely permissioned/surveilled. Then there are the 'minority groups', refugees' groups, civil society groups, advocacy groups for displaced persons etc... in the Middle East, North Africa, South America, the Caucasus, the Balkans...

Plus the anti-censorship groups (like the EFF or others) or who advocate for internet freedom...

Why don't they generally accept Bitcoin? Because today they rarely do despite it being "more accessible" than ever so is it *really* their fault?

Are they just the 'lousy customers' (of the Bitcoin ecosystem)? Or should we stop blaming the customer?

Despite all the nice words on Reddit and Twitter and Nostr (which is virtually unknown) the blocks are mostly empty and are either 1) inherently of low value due to design or 2) of low value to the world because they are *inaccessible* which they aren't.

So what happened? And where do we go from here?

I don't quite understand the situation but something feels fundamentally wrong.

...

If Bitcoin isn't used in the easiest of times, in other words if it cannot protect people as a Store of Value and isn't used as a Medium of Exchange when times are good... then how well will it *really* function when the times are bad?

At the end of the day, the computer should empower and protect people it shouldn't be for control and right now Bitcoin isn't doing either one (empowering or protecting) the way it should.

Either we improve it or we find something else that will - the world will eventually whether we want it to or not.



comparison of some interest

A thousand people can own one Bitcoin transaction.



Ark gets pitched as "the next Lightning." It solves a similar problem – instant, cheap, self-custodial Bitcoin payments – with an almost opposite design. Understanding the difference tells you what each one is actually for.

They solve the same problem two almost-opposite ways.

It's natural to reach for Lightning as the comparison – it's the only other Bitcoin layer running at real scale. But the mechanics share very little. Lightning routes a payment across a chain of bilateral channels; every hop needs its own pre-funded, balanced liquidity, and receiving means either staying online or paying a service to watch for you. Ark has no routing graph at all – a payment simply swaps a share of one pooled output for a share of a new one, cosigned by the ASP, done.

	Lightning	ARK
Structure	Bilateral channel network	One shared UTXO tree
Moving a payment	Routed across hops	Swap share for share, cosigned by ASP
Receiving, first time	Needs inbound liquidity	No setup required
Staying safe offline	Watchtower recommended	Refresh before expiry
Full exit without cooperation	Force-close, 1 tx	O(log n) txs per person
Coordinator	None — permissionless	A named ASP

The two aren't strictly rivals, either. ASPs commonly run a Lightning gateway, letting Ark users send and receive real Lightning payments without operating a Lightning node of their own. And in July 2026, Lightning Labs – the company behind Lightning's most widely used implementation – released an early, Ark-like settlement layer of its own, aimed at agent-to-agent payments. Even the Lightning side sees a use for shared-UTXO batching.

10.6k sats \ 13 comments \ @06bc1a977d 19 Aug lightning

top meme goes in the newsletter

516 sats \ 2 comments \ @sn 17 Aug memes



MEME MONDAY

21 sats \ 0 replies \ @jakoyoh629 17 Aug

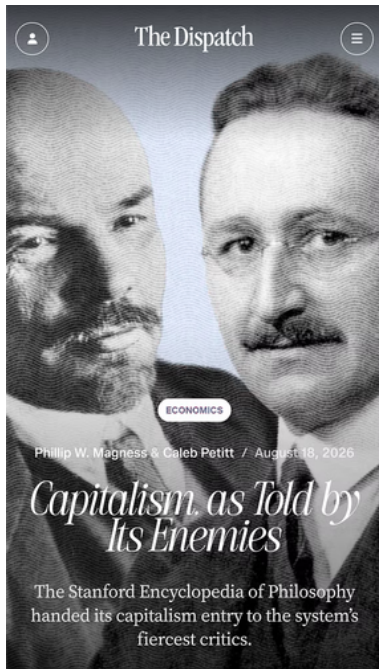


Den has opinions on other's opinions, so we zap him



Capitalism, as Told by Its Enemies (The Dispatch, Phil Magness)

We return to the belabored c-word... (no, not the *cunts*...)



New entry up on the Stanford Encyclopedia of Philosophy (SEP), and it's a complete farce.

"Cordelli's article is loaded with content from the Marxist or socialist far left. Space devoted to critics of capitalism far outpaces even basic descriptions of the economic concept, and proponents of capitalism are reduced to shallow parodies."

"Cordelli's prose functions as an anti-capitalist advocacy piece rather than a neutral and descriptive encyclopedia entry."

"Instead of attempting some semblance of balance, the new SEP entry author Chiara Cordelli, a professor of political philosophy at the University of Chicago, used this

platform to air her own personal grievances with capitalism as an economic system"

"Such imbalances could only emerge from an academic environment in which an ideological echo chamber supplants rigorous peer review, and the fashionable socialist perspectives of the professoriate lead it to mistake bad caricatures of a market economy for descriptive fact."

"In an era when academia is under fire for a well-documented leftward ideological shift as well as declining standards of scholarly rigor, the publication of an encyclopedia entry with a pronounced anti-capitalism skew only confirms the public's declining trust in our university system."

yup, just exit academia already [#1419510](#), [#1087308](#)

Heavy skew in the supporting article/authors: of 169 authors cited half are outright hostile, 8% supportive; for the "Socialism" entry, it's two-thirds of 160 extremely supportive and only *two* overtly critical. Maybe, just, *maybe* you're failing to live up to the standards of an "encyclopedia"

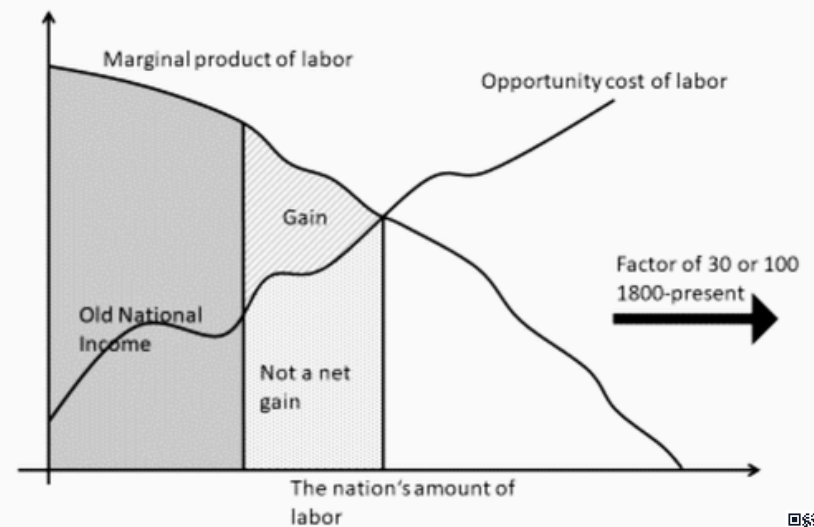
"In addition to the Marxists, Cordelli's entry gives ample space to a stream of non-Marxian socialist and anti-capitalist thinkers such as the sociological historian Karl Polanyi, the far-left economist Thomas Piketty, and self-citations to Cordelli's own writings in the "democratic socialist" tradition."

ridiculous. Word counts, too, excessively skewed toward negative accounts/criticism:

"The author was clearly more concerned with highlighting every minute facet of anti-capitalist academic writing imaginable than with helping readers understand what the concept means, or the reasons that people defend it."

and, ooops:

"Whatever criticisms may be offered of capitalism, **its underlying economic theories have coincided with an unparalleled rise in prosperity and well-being between the late 18th century and today**, often known as the [Great Enrichment](#). By comparison, the Marxist perspectives that dominate Cordelli's work carry the ignominious baggage of mass atrocity and economic ruin in the 20th century, though the phrase "Soviet Union" never appears in her entry."



Gains of efficiency are dwarfed by the Great Enrichment 1800-present



Continued

ALSO, and this will shock the stackers, she's repeatedly *incorrect* in her entry text:

"Almost all the sources used to defend free markets are given superficial treatment, and even those superficial references tend to be wrong. She gives short shrift to economist Friedrich Hayek's work, yet manages to misrepresent those positions that she does discuss, such as when she depicts him as a theorist of equilibrium instead of as a theorist of coordination and information, which are distinct and often contradictory approaches."

"In an illustrative thread on X, Ben Golub, a professor of economics at Northwestern University, identified a number of other basic factual errors in the entry, such as the author's claim that Hayek and Milton Friedman believed that, for capitalism to exist, 'there must be complete, private, and unregulated markets for all 'factors of production,' including capital and labor,' despite both making allowances for regulation and market rules."

The labor theory of value just assumed

"Cordelli also opens the first section of her entry with Marx's definition of capitalism and makes reference to the 'labor theory of value' without acknowledging that this concept has been considered obsolete by mainstream economists since the 1870s."

yesyes, we know: Marxian economists *still* thinks this is a reasonable and valuable approach [#1471628](#)

"Yet Cordelli proceeds as if Marx's economic theories remain intact, ultimately devoting some 800 words spread across two different sections of the entry to exegesis on 'surplus value.' That's more verbiage on a single debunked Marxian concept than she provides to the entirety of Friedman's work."

"This is a philosophical equivalent of treating geocentrism or flat-earth theory as valid and useful ideas."

Another world is possible

"a better entry might include serious engagement with the Scottish Enlightenment precursors to the emergence of market capitalism in the late 18th century, with references to David Hume's work on trade and currency, as well as something more than superficial references to Adam Smith. It might also discuss how the ideas we call 'capitalism' came to supplant an older mercantilist economic order that used government policies to steer an economy for nationalistic objectives."

== "As it stands, this rich and complex academic literature receives nary a mention beyond a few passing citations."

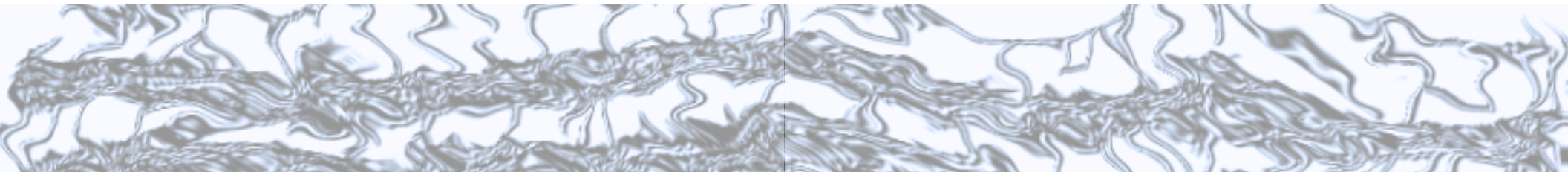
This is a pretty basic and reasonable ask:

"Since capitalism is fundamentally an economic concept, one could reasonably expect to see mainstream economic voices discussed, and competently so, by someone versed in economic theory. There would be a clear description of how profits work both as signals of demand and incentives for entrepreneurship, how competition between firms disciplines market actors, how market prices make economic calculation possible by signaling the relative scarcity of goods in a common denominator, and how government policies contribute to the creation of monopolies

Welfarist arguments for capitalism would not be confined to a single paragraph, and would describe in detail how free-market capitalism has been responsible for lifting the world out of poverty. The way that capitalism incentivizes entrepreneurship, and the role entrepreneurs play in arbitrage and the creation of new goods and services, would play a more important role than the entry's single paragraph on Joseph Schumpeter, the first economist to make entrepreneurship central to the understanding of economic development and change."

I don't know why people keep insisting on fairytales... Ms Cordelli, Mr. Beckett, Mr. Piketty et al -- have you guys tried feeling differently?

...





I closed my node c-otto.de



tl;dr: I started a lightning node in 05/2018 and shut it down in 08/2026. It was fun.

Node history and some statistics (05/2025): #922297

After eight years of running the lightning node c-otto.de, I closed all channels and will stop the node once everything is settled. I won't talk about my motivation to do so (private reasons), but I can say that nothing major happened.

My node forwarded 1,382,310 transactions (how many full blocks did that save?) and had 3,444 channels. Of those, 2,898 were closed cooperatively (84.1%), 145 were force closed by my peer, 401 were force closed by my node. I opened 789 channels myself, while 2,467 channels were opened by others. For 188 very old channels I can't see the initiator right now.

Forwards:

- Largest: 160,130,043 sat (1.6 BTC) from okx to LOOP, 11/2025
- Runner-up: 94,764,890 sat (0.9 BTC) from Binance to LOOP, 07/2024
- Average: 124,026 sat
- Median: 20,003 sat
- 90th percentile: 214,000 sat
- 95th percentile: 462,925 sat

Special thanks to folks who sent me sats via keysend (361x a single sat, 83x 10 sat), and the very few peers who opened channels to me with the --push-amt option (intentionally, I hope).

Thanks a lot to everyone in the Lightning Network community, researchers (esp. René Pickhardt and Stefan Richter), everyone taking care of Ind (Lightning Labs, and other contributors), and others I forgot to mention here.

See you around,
Carsten

Do you think you have attained freedom from predatory violence?



I've had this phrase in my head lately:

"Freedom from predatory violence will allow the cybereconomy to grow at far higher compound rates of growth than conventional economies dominated by nation-states."

or at least, that's the literal quote; I was thinking about this in terms of mostly the first part of it. I had to search where I got it from, turns out it's from *The Sovereign Individual*, chapter 7.

In light of recent developments regarding the security of sats, we've clearly not realized this. People saying "I've done everything right, yet I lost my entire stack" is evidence that what consensus (per sentiment, consensus = the tweeter/podcast sphere) **says** is right, doesn't have to actually **be** right and the consequence is unmitigated vulnerability. After all, an **unmitigated vulnerability** in software that you run becomes your vulnerability: you inherit it.

The nation-state after all isn't the only predator; there are many more predators out there that may be worse for your your freedom than the state, if they target you.

Do you think you have attained any level of freedom from predatory violence?

And if yes, what are the tradeoffs you made?

Discussion

238 sats \ 3 replies \ @Scoresby 22 Aug

It seems to me that IRL predatory violence from the state and predatory violence from others are opposites of sorts. If the state is strong, it seems that I have less likelihood of getting brutalized in my bed by a wrench attack. But if I don't pay my taxes, I'll go to a jail where they brutalize me in my bed.

Cyberspace (or the cybereconomy) is different: the state doesn't seem to be able to protect me very well in that realm. I've been scammed online before and I've had my data sold and leaked to everyone and I don't really know how secure my devices are (I have not yet discovered an attack, but given my abilities, this doesn't mean much). ... *<he has more to say, go online to read, good exchange>*